# Travel Never Smelt Sweeter



Kannauj, where delicate fragrances have been distilled the traditional way using copper stills for centuries, has always been the unofficial perfume capital of India. Now, thanks to eighth-generation perfume scion Pranav Kapoor of Indian Naturals, visitors can enjoy an immersive perfume tour of Kannauj consisting of visits to an archaeological museum, flower plantation and perfume distillery. Stays are in the Courtyard Suite at 24 MG Road, the ancestral home and heritage perfumery dating from 1912. While the family stays upstairs, the ground floor with the perfumery has been refurbished for the guest experience and includes a fragrance gallery, perfume bar and the suite.



Guests get to create their signature scent, identify ingredients and blend at the perfume bar here. Multi-course gourmet meals are rustled up by Pranav himself who happens to be a trained chef. The haveli will offer more rooms from next year and another seven-room property, centred around fragrance inspired from 6th-century Kannauj, is in the works.

*Tariff: The perfume tour costs Rs 15,000. Stay at the Courtyard Suite is Rs 15,000 per night*

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## BRIDGE WITH A VIEW

You no longer have to fly to China for your glass bridge fix. Just head to Vagamon in Kerala. India's longest cantilever glass bridge opened to visitors at this charming hill station in Idukki district in August. The 40 metre-long skywalk bridge at 'Suicide Point' (don't get any ideas) is made of five layers of 40 mm glass imported from Germany and offers panoramic views of the surrounding landscape. Thirty-five tonnes of steel support the entire construction, comprising six metal cables that attach the bridge to steel pillars on the mountain's summit. On popular demand, the entry fee has been slashed by half to Rs 250.





## All Quiet on the Western Front

After war comes peace and, hopefully, tourism follows in due course. The road from Gurez in Kashmir to the Mushkoh Valley in Kargil's Drass sector is now open to tourists. The route goes over Kaobal Gali, a scenic high-altitude pass perched at an elevation of 4,167 metres above sea level. Mushkoh Valley is, of course, the site of the Kargil War and has been off limits to civilians after 1999. Now Mushkoh, strewn with meadows of wild tulips, beckons once more.